



Family Cyber Plan

HOME NETWORK HARDENING & DIGITAL CHILD SAFETY FRAMEWORK

Modern households are micro-networks containing dozens of interconnected devices, ranging from smart televisions to remote schooling laptops. Protecting your family requires an intentional defense strategy that safeguards infrastructure from unauthorized intrusions while providing a structured, secure environment for children to discover the digital world.

1. Router & Wireless Network Hardening

Your home wireless router is the primary gateway between external network threats and your family's personal storage arrays. Leaving it at default factory settings exposes internal traffic to credential compromises.

Mandatory Router Safety Configuration Suite

- **Modify Administrative Access:** Change the default login username and password for the router interface panel (typically found under `192.168.1.1` or `192.168.0.1`). This is entirely distinct from your Wi-Fi network password.
- **Enforce Modern Wireless Encryption:** Ensure your network utilizes **WPA3-Personal** encryption. If legacy devices require backward compatibility, select **WPA2/WPA3 Mixed Mode**. Never allow open networks or outdated WEP profiles.
- **Deactivate Remote Administration:** Disable any feature that permits system management via an external web link. Management access should be strictly bound to locally hardwired or authenticated wireless clients.
- **Turn Off WPS and UPnP:** Disable Wi-Fi Protected Setup (WPS) and Universal Plug and Play (UPnP). These automated pairing utilities contain documented protocol vulnerabilities commonly targeted by network sniffing scripts.

The Power of Segregated Networks

Most contemporary routers offer multi-SSID configurations. Create three distinct internal networks to compartmentalize risks:

1. **Primary Network:** For trusted personal computing equipment, banking terminals, and private storage devices.
2. **Guest Network:** For visiting guests and children's temporary gaming devices. Ensure "Intranet Isolation" is enabled so guest clients cannot view or communicate with your primary devices.
3. **IoT/Smart Home Network:** For smart appliances, security cameras, and connected thermostats. Smart devices often have unpatched vulnerabilities; keeping them isolated prevents a compromise from bleeding into your primary workstations.

2. Practical Home Cybersecurity Checklists

Maintain a regular operational cadence using the following preventive maintenance lists to establish structural digital hygiene:

Monthly Maintenance Checklist

- ☐ Verify router firmware updates.
- ☐ Review connected client lists on router dashboard.
- ☐ Inspect cloud backup statuses for active family devices.
- ☐ Run local antimalware deep scans on household laptops.
- ☐ Purge unused applications and old temporary files.

Bi-Annual Identity Checklist

- ☐ Audit streaming account authorized device lists.
- ☐ Verify active MFA configuration profiles.
- ☐ Run credit monitoring reviews via official platforms.
- ☐ Test recovery email addresses and backup mobile links.
- ☐ Rotate core master passphrases on password vaults.

3. Guidelines for Keeping Children Safe Online

Technological barriers are only half the battle. Digital parenting requires clear, tiered age frameworks that blend technical enforcement with foundational conversation.

Age Group Focus	Technical Guardrails & Controls	Behavioral & Educational Foundations
Early Childhood (Ages 5 – 9)	• Implement strict DNS filtering (e.g., Cloudflare Families 1.1.1.3) to auto-block adult media content. • Restrict access to whitelist-only child portals.	• Enforce a rule where screens are only used in shared family common rooms. • Establish digital use limits clearly.
Pre-Teens (Ages 10 – 13)	• Activate moderated search rules inside engines (Google SafeSearch). • Disable in-app transaction modules on gaming devices.	• Instruct them to never disclose birthdates, physical school names, or locations. • Encourage reporting of cyberbullying.

Age Group Focus	Technical Guardrails & Controls	Behavioral & Educational Foundations
Adolescents (Ages 14 – 18)	• Transition to transparency audits over absolute application blocking blocks. • Enforce device-free bedroom zones overnight.	• Educate on the permanence of digital prints and histories. • Deconstruct phishing mechanics and downloading risks.

Core Safety Directive: The Secure DNS Layer

Instead of installing invasive surveillance software on individual phones, modify your home router’s upstream DNS settings to point to free family security servers, such as **Cloudflare Family (1.1.1.3 / 1.0.0.3)** or **AdGuard Home Family**. This instantly prevents any device connected to your household Wi-Fi from resolving malicious domain queries or opening mature web hubs.

4. Emergency Threat Response Steps

If a family member falls victim to a digital compromise or encounters an identity exposure scenario, proceed immediately through these structural triage parameters:

1. **Account Isolation:** If a personal profile is breached, log in from a separate, secure node, trigger a "Force Logout on All Active Sessions," and instantly change the primary passphrase.
2. **Financial System Freezes:** In cases where banking credentials or social security elements are involved, access credit bureau websites instantly to issue a **Credit Freeze**. This prevents malicious third parties from initiating loans or credit profiles under your names.
3. **Evidence Log Preservation:** Do not erase communication strings. Retain transactional records, target email addresses, and malicious web paths. These files are essential when presenting reports to cybercrime authorities or banking protection services.